

# Doctor Visit Prep Pack

Walk into a ten-minute appointment with your symptoms, timeline, medications and questions already on paper.

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## How to use this journal

## THE ROUTINE

- ## THE SCALE YOU WILL USE

## WHAT THE NUMBERS MEAN

- ## WHAT I WANT TO GET OUT OF THIS

# Symptom summary

If you hand over only one page, make it this one.

|      |               |       |
|------|---------------|-------|
| NAME | DATE OF BIRTH | TODAY |
|      |               |       |

THE MAIN PROBLEM, IN ONE SENTENCE

THE ESSENTIALS

| QUESTION | ANSWER |
|----------|--------|
|          |        |
|          |        |
|          |        |
|          |        |
|          |        |

TYPICAL PAIN LEVEL

|      |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |       |
|------|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|-------|
| 0    | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10    |
| NONE |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   | WORST |

WHAT IT STOPS ME DOING

# Symptom timeline

Work backwards from today. Calendars, photos and messages are better than memory.

TIMELINE

| DATE | WHAT CHANGED | HOW BAD | WHAT I DID ABOUT IT |
|------|--------------|---------|---------------------|
|      |              |         |                     |
|      |              |         |                     |
|      |              |         |                     |
|      |              |         |                     |
|      |              |         |                     |
|      |              |         |                     |
|      |              |         |                     |
|      |              |         |                     |
|      |              |         |                     |
|      |              |         |                     |

REFERENCE

Medications & allergies

Include supplements, herbal remedies and anything bought over the counter — these interact too.

CURRENTLY TAKING

| NAME | DOSE | HOW OFTEN | SINCE | WHAT FOR | PRESCRIBED BY |
|------|------|-----------|-------|----------|---------------|
|      |      |           |       |          |               |
|      |      |           |       |          |               |
|      |      |           |       |          |               |
|      |      |           |       |          |               |
|      |      |           |       |          |               |
|      |      |           |       |          |               |

STOPPED, AND WHY

| NAME | TAKEN UNTIL | WHY STOPPED |
|------|-------------|-------------|
|      |             |             |
|      |             |             |
|      |             |             |
|      |             |             |
|      |             |             |
|      |             |             |

ALLERGIES AND BAD REACTIONS

BEFORE

## Questions to ask

Number them. You will not get through all of them, so the order is the important part.

## MY QUESTIONS, MOST IMPORTANT FIRST

**WORTH ASKING IF IT APPLIES**

- ☐ What is the most likely cause?
  - ☐ Do I need any tests?
  - ☐ How long before I should see improvement?
  - ☐ Should I be referred to a specialist?
  - ☐ What else could it be?
  - ☐ What should I do if it gets worse?
  - ☐ Are there side effects to watch for?
  - ☐ What can I do myself in the meantime?

DURING

# Appointment notes

Write while they talk. Ask them to slow down — that is entirely normal.

| DATE | WHO I SAW | CLINIC |
|------|-----------|--------|
|      |           |        |

WHAT THEY SAID THE PROBLEM IS

WORDS I DID NOT UNDERSTAND — ASK BEFORE LEAVING

TREATMENT OR MEDICATION STARTED

TESTS OR REFERRALS ORDERED

AFTER

After-visit plan

Fill this in before you drive home, while it is still fresh.

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

| ACTION | WHO DOES IT | BY WHEN | DONE |
|--------|-------------|---------|------|
|        |             |         |      |
|        |             |         |      |
|        |             |         |      |
|        |             |         |      |

TESTS & REFERRALS TO CHASE

| WHAT | BOOKED FOR | CHASED ON | RESULT RECEIVED |
|------|------------|-----------|-----------------|
|      |            |           |                 |
|      |            |           |                 |
|      |            |           |                 |
|      |            |           |                 |
|      |            |           |                 |

COME BACK IF...

NEXT APPOINTMENT



## FREE SPACE

## Notes & questions for next time

Anything the structured pages did not capture.

DATE \_\_\_\_\_

TOPIC

## Before you start

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These pages are a personal record-keeping tool. They are not a medical device, they do not diagnose anything, and nothing here is medical advice.

Tracking is useful because it turns vague memory into specifics you can hand to a professional: when it started, what makes it worse, what you already tried. It is not a substitute for seeing one.

See a qualified healthcare professional about any new, severe, or worsening symptom. Seek urgent care for chest pain, numbness or weakness in a limb, loss of bladder or bowel control, severe headache of sudden onset, pain following an accident, fever with neck stiffness, or any symptom that frightens you.

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